Karma: the belief shared by Hindu, Buddhist and Jaina traditions that deliberately performed actions generate a residue that stays with the agent until future circumstances are appropriate for its fruition in their experience. Everyone has an inherited store of merit and demerit and it is this that makes them the person and character that they are. Hindus and Jains think that ***karma*** is associated with the soul (***atman***), which is the constant principle that remains the same through the succession of embodied lives. Buddhists reject the soul and think that ***karma*** is a natural mechanism organised into streams of experiences. They also insist that it is the intention with which the action is done that is morally significant.

There are three types: *karmic* dispositions whose consequences are manifested in the present life; *karmic* dispositions latent in the present life that will be actualised in future lives; fresh ***karma*** that is the product of actions being performed in this life.

The theory is not deterministic in that one's character and life have been imposed from the outside. ***Karma*** is a matter of what one chooses and does oneself.

Further reading: Gombrich 1994; Halbfass 1991; O'Flaherty 1980

Karman (action/motion): according to ***Vaisheshika***, this is one of the objectively real types of features (***padartha***) belonging to the cosmos. Motions (elevation and descent, expansion, contraction and change of place) are transitory properties of persisting entities. It is also the efficient cause of conjunction or the putting together of two objects.

Karma-nirapeksha (regardless of ***karma***): the view that when at the end of a period of cosmic retraction (***Pralaya***) God produces a new universe, his organisation of the initial state of affairs is totally independent of the